



ON-PAGE SEO AUDIT REPORT

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About Optimum Skills

Company overview & audit snapshot



About the Company

Optimum Skills is a leading North East training and apprenticeship provider based in Newton Aycliffe, UK.

Their vision to "*Optimise Potential*" is delivered through outstanding quality training that supports individuals with careers and businesses with growth.

They serve:

- Employers & Businesses
- Apprentices & Job Seekers
- Existing Staff (Upskilling)
- Construction Academy
- Training Courses

Audit Overview Grades

B

Overall Audit

D

On-Page SEO

C

Links

B

Usability

B

Performance

A

Social



Priority focus: On-Page SEO grade is D — immediate action needed

Title Tag Optimization

On-Page SEO Element

CURRENT STATUS

Title: "Home - Optimum Skills"

Length: 21 characters — too short for effective SEO

ISSUE

Does not describe the page topic or include primary keywords. Search engines need 50–60 characters to display a meaningful snippet.

RECOMMENDATION

Rewrite the title tag to 50–60 characters, including the brand name and primary keyword.

Suggested: Optimum Skills | Training and Apprenticeships in the UK
(Length: 56 characters ✓)

Home - Optimum Skills

Meta Description Optimization

On-Page SEO Element

CURRENT STATUS

Current length: 239 characters — exceeds the recommended 120–160 character limit

ISSUE

Google truncates meta descriptions longer than ~160 characters. This reduces visibility, click appeal, and message clarity in search results.

RECOMMENDATION

Write a concise, action-focused meta description under 160 characters.

Suggested:

"Optimum Skills helps employers, apprentices, and staff with quality training and apprenticeship solutions across the UK."

(Length: 117 characters ✓)

Optimum Skills are a leading North East training and apprenticeship provider. Explore our apprenticeship and training opportunities.

Heading Tag Structure

On-Page SEO Element

CURRENT STATUS

Multiple H1 tags detected. Current structure: H2×4, H3×8, H4×9 — no single clear H1

ISSUE

Duplicate H1 tags confuse search engines about the page's primary topic. Only one H1 per page is best practice.

RECOMMENDED STRUCTURE

H1 — Apprenticeship and Training Solutions
H2 — Employers
H2 — Apprentices
H2 — Upskill My Staff
H3 — Supporting details under each section

H1 tags- 6

- Training for your Team
- Join the Team
- What the Latest DWP Apprenticeship Reforms Mean for Employers and How Optimum Skills Can Support You
- Building Futures: Celebrating Women in Construction
- Our Next Chapter: Introducing the New Optimum Skills
- Optimise your Potential

Keyword Targeting & Distribution

On-Page SEO Element

ISSUE

Keywords are not strategically distributed across title tags, meta descriptions, headings, and body content. Brand terms dominate.

RECOMMENDATION

Assign one primary keyword theme per page. Support with secondary terms.

Conduct cannibalization review: check for overlapping keywords across similar pages (e.g. /employers and /apprenticeships) to prevent internal competition.

Observed Main Keywords

optimum

construction

skills

training

employers

apprenticeship

Image Optimization

On-Page SEO Element

ISSUE

Missing ALT attributes on 6 images weakens accessibility and image search visibility.

RECOMMENDED ALT TEXT EXAMPLES

- "Apprenticeship training session at Optimum Skills"
- "Optimum Skills classroom workshop, Newton Aycliffe"
- "Employer skills development programme, North East"
- "Construction Academy practical training session"

All 14 images must have descriptive, keyword-relevant ALT text.

14

Total Images

6

Missing ALT

8

Have ALT Text

Robots & Indexing Signals

Technical SEO Review

RECOMMENDATION

Keep all valuable pages open to crawling and indexing. Reserve robots.txt exclusions for low-value pages (e.g. admin, staging, duplicate parameters).

Positive Findings

- ✓ Noindex tag NOT used
- ✓ Noindex header NOT used
- ✓ Page NOT blocked by robots.txt
- ✓ XML Sitemap available

Canonical Tag Review

Technical SEO Review

WHY THIS MATTERS

Canonical tags tell search engines the preferred URL version of a page. They prevent duplicate content issues when similar content appears at multiple URLs.

RECOMMENDATION

Audit canonical consistency across all key pages — especially for:

- Pages accessible via HTTP & HTTPS
- www vs non-www versions
- Paginated or filtered URLs
- Mobile vs desktop versions

Ensure self-referencing canonicals are in place on all key landing pages.

✓ **Canonical tag is PRESENT**

<https://optimumskills.co.uk/>

Language Tag & Hreflang

Technical SEO Review

CURRENT SITUATION

The site targets the UK market only, so a missing hreflang is acceptable for now. The en-US language tag is present but could be switched to en-GB.

RECOMMENDATION

Short term: Update language tag from en-US to en-GB to better reflect UK targeting.

Long term: If the website expands to serve multiple regions or languages, implement hreflang to guide search engines to the correct regional version.

Example: `<link rel="alternate" hreflang="en-GB" href="https://optimumskills.co.uk/" />`

✓ **Language Tag**

Set to: en-US

⚠ **Hreflang**

Not Implemented

URL Structure Optimization

On-Page SEO Element

ISSUE

Some current URLs use long filenames, code strings, or special characters that reduce readability and keyword clarity for users and search engines.

RECOMMENDATION

Use short, descriptive, lowercase, hyphen-separated URLs. Remove unnecessary parameters and inline styles from URL strings.

URL Structure Examples

✗ **Avoid** /page?id=234&cat=training&src=homepage

✓ **Better** /training-courses/

✓ **Better** /apprenticeships/

✓ **Better** /employer-support/

Internal & External Link Optimization

On-Page SEO Element

INSIGHT

Strong internal link base is a positive signal for crawl flow. 10 external follow links should be reviewed to ensure all link to high-authority, relevant sources.

RECOMMENDATION

Strengthen internal linking between:

- Homepage ↔ Course Pages
- Apprenticeships ↔ Employer Pages
- Construction Academy ↔ Case Studies
- All key pages ↔ Contact Page

Add nofollow to any outbound links that don't support user trust or editorial value.

80

Total Links

70

Internal

10

External (Follow)

0

Nofollow

Schema Markup Review

Technical SEO Element

GAP IDENTIFIED

No Local Business Schema was detected. This is a key opportunity for a UK-based training provider with multiple physical locations.

Recommended Schema Types

LocalBusiness

Organization

Service

BreadcrumbList

FAQPage

✓ JSON-LD Schema is present on the page

Social Preview Tag Optimization

Open Graph & Twitter Cards

Social Presence Audit

RECOMMENDATION

Excellent social presence! Keep Open Graph titles, descriptions and images updated with every key page change.

Ensure OG images are 1200×630px for best display across all platforms. Regular updates support branded visibility and click-through performance.

✓ Facebook Open Graph

✓ Facebook Page Linked

✓ Instagram Profile

✓ YouTube Channel

✓ Twitter / X Cards

✓ X / Twitter Profile

✓ LinkedIn Page

Video Content Optimization

Content & Engagement

Content Opportunities

- Apprenticeship journey explanations
- Employer training benefits & ROI
- Construction Academy highlights
- Student & employer success stories

RECOMMENDATION

Each video page should include:

- Descriptive keyword-rich title
- Full transcript (aids indexing and accessibility)
- VideoObject schema markup
- Keyword-focused description with timestamps

Embed key videos directly on relevant service pages.

✓ YouTube channel is linked on the page — positive signal

Content Depth & Voice Search

Content Quality Review

ISSUE

261 words is considered thin content. The 4% rendered content level signals that much page content is JavaScript-dependent and may not be crawled effectively.

RECOMMENDATION

Increase page text content with:

- Expand service pages to 600–1000+ words
- Service explanations and FAQs
- Location and regional references
- Benefits for employers and apprentices

Voice Search: Add question-based content:

- "What apprenticeship training does Optimum Skills offer?"
- "How can employers fund apprenticeship training in the UK?"
- "Where is Optimum Skills based?"

261

Words on Page

4%

Rendered Content

Priority Action Plan (30 Day Action Plan)



Structured Fix Roadmap

PHASE 1 — Core Fixes (Week 1)

- Rewrite title tag (50–60 chars)
- Shorten meta description (<160 chars)
- Remove duplicate H1 tags
- Add ALT text to all 6 missing images
- Review canonical & robots signals

PHASE 2 — Content Improvement (Week 2-3)

- Increase page word count (800+ words)
- Improve keyword placement in headings & body
- Strengthen internal linking structure
- Add FAQ & voice-search optimised content

PHASE 3 — Technical Enhancement (Week 3-4)

- Add Local Business Schema markup
- Remove plain-text email addresses
- Improve URL structure & readability
- Audit and clean inline styles & JS-dependencies

Expected Outcomes (90 Days)

If Recommendations Are Implemented

Stronger Keyword Relevance

Pages rank for targeted terms with clearer topical signals across metadata and content.

Improved On-Page SEO Grade

Addressing title, meta, H1, and content issues can lift the D grade to B or above.

Better Accessibility

ALT text and semantic structure improve compliance and inclusivity.

Cleaner Page Structure

Single H1, proper hierarchy, and descriptive URLs improve readability.

Stronger Search Snippets

Optimised title and meta description increase click-through rates in SERPs.

Improved Trust & Usability

Schema, canonical tags, and internal links build credibility and user experience.

Conclusion

On-Page SEO Audit Summary

✓ Optimum Skills has a solid technical foundation — good indexing signals, canonical tags, schema usage, strong social presence, and a clean robots setup.

Key Opportunities

- Better content structure & keyword targeting
- Improved image optimisation (ALT text on 6 images)
- Cleaner metadata (title tag & meta description)
- Richer content depth & voice search readiness
- Local Business Schema & URL improvements

Biggest Wins

Fixing the title tag, meta description, H1 structure, image ALT text, and content depth will deliver the greatest and fastest SEO improvement.

Recommended Next Step

Implement Phase 1 core fixes within 2 weeks. Move to Phase 2 content improvements, then Phase 3 technical enhancements. Schedule a follow-up audit in 60 days.



Questions & Discussion



Thank You

Ready to Optimise Your Potential?

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